TidyTuesday Week 33

Pranay Gundam

Thursday 13th August, 2026

Contents

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only recurring column on the internet where we throw two completely unrelated economic time series into a blender and act deeply moved by whatever comes out. This week the machine served up a spicy inflation index against a discontinued interest rate benchmark, a defunct Swiss central bank intervention log against manufacturers' order ratios, and, for the grand finale, Asian air freight import prices against how many people were hiring for burger-flipping jobs on Indeed. Truly the intellectual heirs of Newton and Keynes are shaking in their boots.

Monday, August 10, gave us our headline act: the Chained CPI for Services versus the 1-Week AMERIBOR term structure, and oh boy, the raw regression came out swinging with an R-squared of 0.93. Ninety-three percent! Somebody call Stockholm! Except, as any regular reader of this dunk-tank of a newsletter already suspects, both series just spent their overlapping lives drifting upward like two balloons let go at the same birthday party. Once we detrend and strip that shared drift out, the R-squared collapses to a much more humble 0.23. Now, to be fair, that detrended relationship is still technically "significant" at the usual thresholds, which is more than most of our contestants can say – so I'll grudgingly admit this one didn't completely evaporate. It went from "revolutionary discovery" to "eh, maybe there's a faint something," which in this project counts as a rousing success. Do not, under any circumstances, build a portfolio on it.

Wednesday, August 12, was the day the math simply gave up. Pairing decades-old Swiss National Bank USD-against-DEM purchases with a transportation-equipment order ratio produced an R-squared of roughly 0.0000000000000003, a slope of exactly zero, and a parade of p-values that just said "nan" like a confused toddler. The design matrix was reportedly singular, which is a polite statistical way of saying the two series had absolutely nothing to say to each other and the software knew it. A moment of silence for the numbers that died so this row of the CSV could exist. Then Thursday's air-freight-versus-fast-food-job-postings matchup limped in with an R-squared of 0.02 raw and a p-value hovering around a deeply unconvincing 0.19, meaning it wasn't significant in the raw version and stayed just as unimpressive after detrending. Consistency! Just... consistently nothing.

As always, the mandatory reminder for anyone who wandered in expecting rigor: these pairs are chosen at random, nobody is claiming Swiss currency interventions cause anything, and spurious correlation isn't a bug here, it's the entire genre. The one takeaway worth keeping is the meta-lesson the CPI/AMERIBOR pair illustrates so nicely – a jaw-dropping 0.93 in levels means almost nothing on its own, and the only reason we even raise an eyebrow at that pair is that a sliver of it survived detrending. Everything else this week was, statistically speaking, two strangers waving at each other from different trains. See you next week for more.

2 Date: 2026-08-10

Series ID: SUUR0000SAS

This series is titled Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1999=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1999-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: AMBOR1W

This series is titled 1-Week AMERIBOR Term Structure of Interest Rates (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2021-06-20 and the observation end date is 2023-12-27.The popularity of this series is 2.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W	**R-squared:**	0.930
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.927
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	319.1
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	2.29e-15
Time:	12:39:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-23.378
No. Observations:	26	**AIC:**	50.76
Df Residuals:	24	**BIC:**	53.27
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-50.4524	2.976	-16.953	0.000	-56.595	-44.310
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS	0.2849	0.016	17.863	0.000	0.252	0.318

Omnibus:	3.117	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.210	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	2.425
Skew:	-0.614	**Prob(JB):**	0.297
Kurtosis:	2.147	**Cond. No.**	4.58e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.58e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

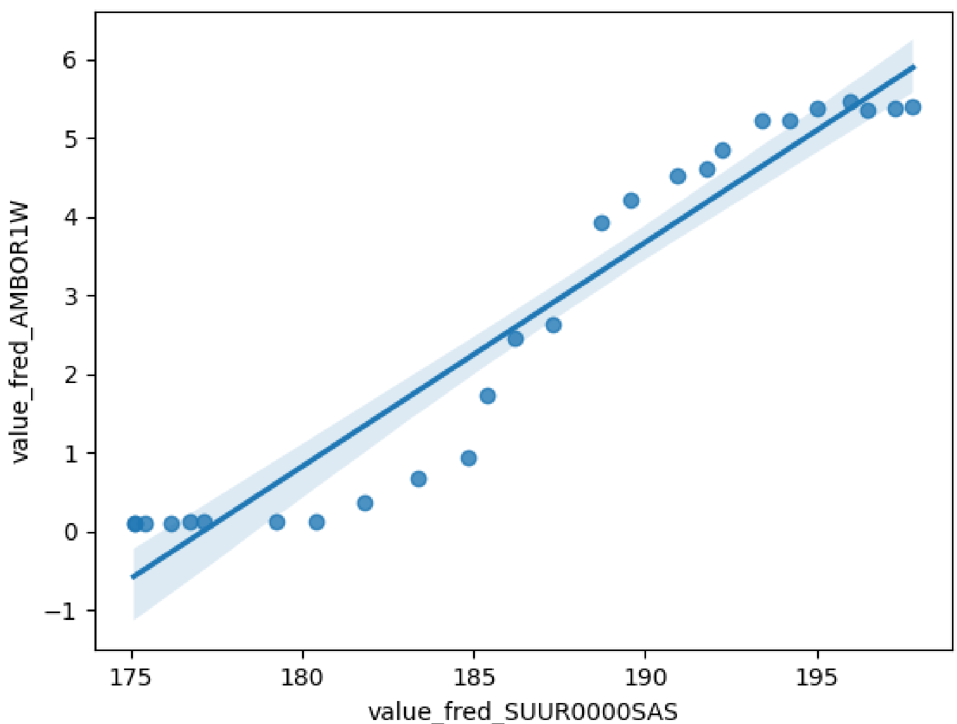

Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.227
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.195
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	7.062
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0138
Time:	12:39:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-23.173
No. Observations:	26	**AIC:**	50.35
Df Residuals:	24	**BIC:**	52.86
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.455e-11	0.120	-1.21e-10	1.000	-0.249	0.249
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS_detrended	0.3703	0.139	2.657	0.014	0.083	0.658

Omnibus:	3.443	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.285
Prob(Omnibus):	0.179	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.012
Skew:	-0.790	**Prob(JB):**	0.222
Kurtosis:	2.467	**Cond. No.**	1.16

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

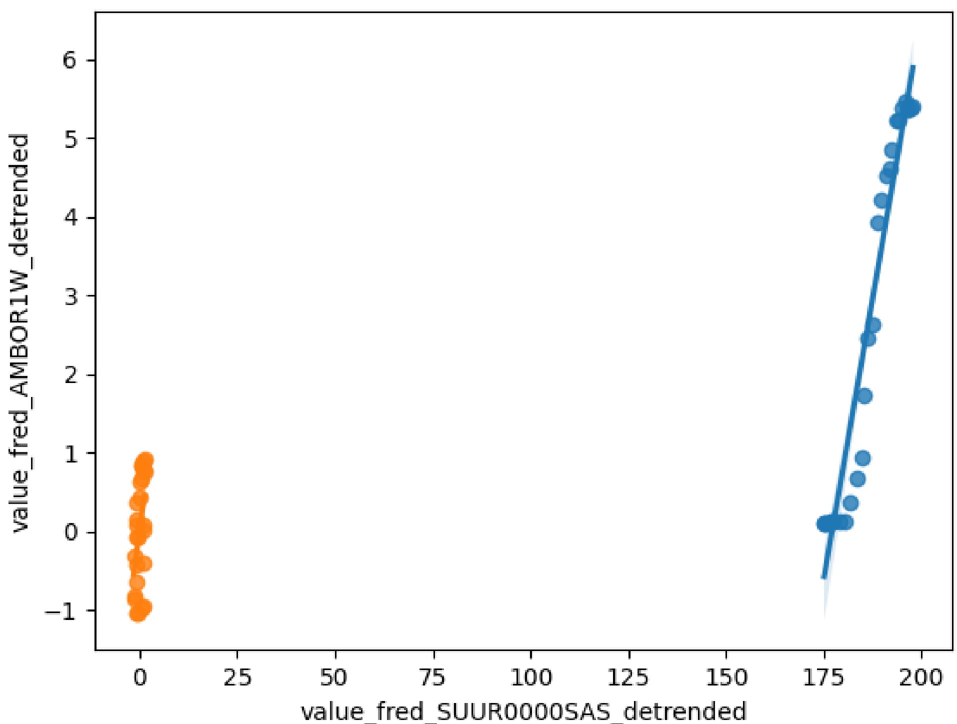

Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

3 Date: 2026-08-12

Series ID: CHINTDUSDDM

This series is titled Swiss Intervention: Swiss National Bank Purchases of USD against DEM (Millions of USD) and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Millions of USD and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1975-01-01 and the observation end date is 1998-12-31.The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: U36SUS

This series is titled Manufacturers' Unfilled Orders to Shipments Ratios: Transportation Equipment and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Ratio and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	nan
Time:	12:39:50	**Log-Likelihood:**	-151.34
No. Observations:	84	**AIC:**	304.7
Df Residuals:	83	**BIC:**	307.1
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	9.3852	0.161	58.316	0.000	9.065	9.705
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	19.125	**Durbin-Watson:**	1.105
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	23.295
Skew:	1.168	**Prob(JB):**	8.74e-06
Kurtosis:	4.095	**Cond. No.**	inf

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The smallest eigenvalue is 0. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

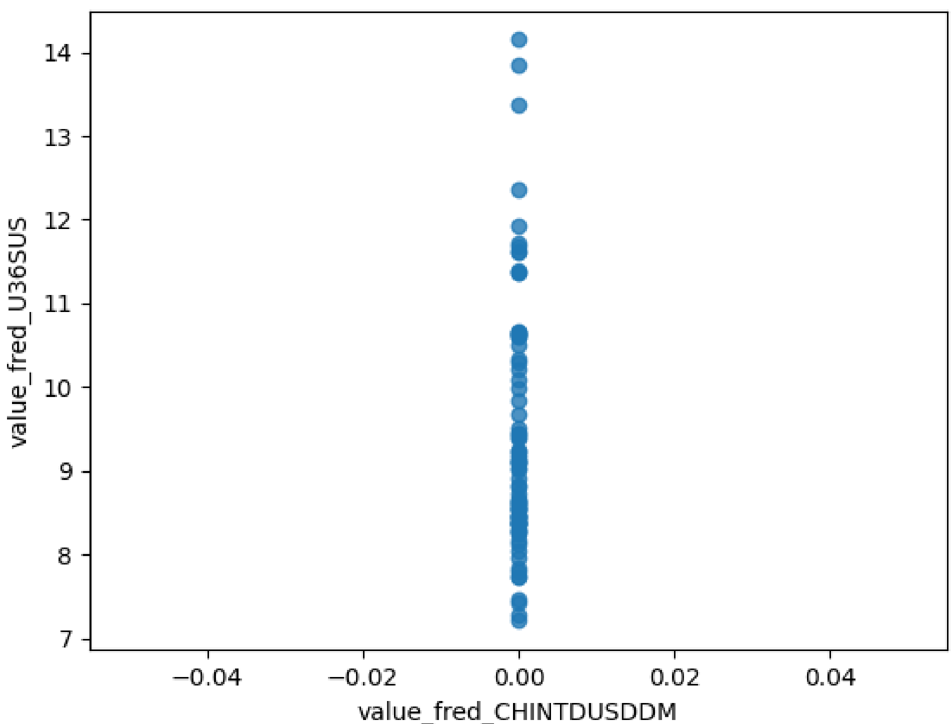

Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-12

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	nan
Time:	12:39:50	**Log-Likelihood:**	-134.10
No. Observations:	84	**AIC:**	270.2
Df Residuals:	83	**BIC:**	272.6
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-8.19e-13	0.131	-6.25e-12	1.000	-0.261	0.261
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	21.603	**Durbin-Watson:**	1.662
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	27.747
Skew:	1.266	**Prob(JB):**	9.44e-07
Kurtosis:	4.233	**Cond. No.**	inf

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The smallest eigenvalue is 0. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

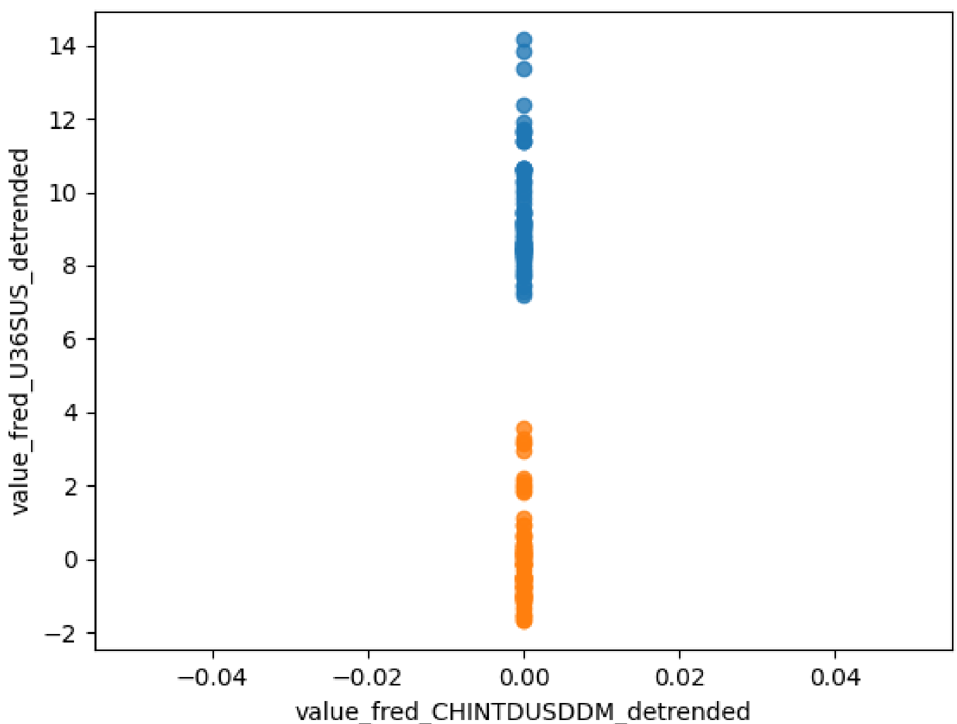

Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-12

4 Date: 2026-08-13

Series ID: IV1312

This series is titled Import Price Index (Balance of Payments): Air Freight for Asia and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1990-09-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE

This series is titled Food Preparation and Service Job Postings on Indeed in the United States and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Index Feb, 1 2020=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2020-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-07.The popularity of this series is 6.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE	**R-squared:**	0.023
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.010
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	1.750
Date:	Thu, 13 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.190
Time:	12:40:03	**Log-Likelihood:**	-335.82
No. Observations:	76	**AIC:**	675.6
Df Residuals:	74	**BIC:**	680.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	95.2838	12.490	7.629	0.000	70.398	120.170
value_fred_IV1312	0.0574	0.043	1.323	0.190	-0.029	0.144

Omnibus:	8.845	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.102
Prob(Omnibus):	0.012	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	8.702
Skew:	-0.813	**Prob(JB):**	0.0129
Kurtosis:	3.319	**Cond. No.**	1.54e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.54e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

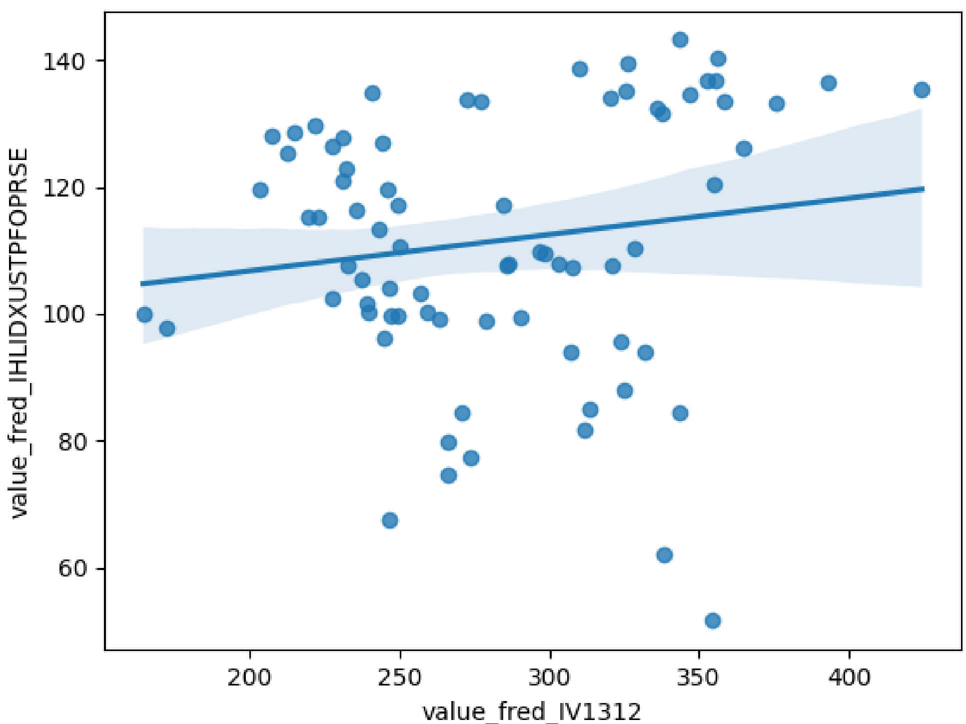

Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-13

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.034
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.021
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	2.578
Date:	Thu, 13 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.113
Time:	12:40:03	**Log-Likelihood:**	-335.22
No. Observations:	76	**AIC:**	674.4
Df Residuals:	74	**BIC:**	679.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.576e-11	2.316	-6.81e-12	1.000	-4.614	4.614
value_fred_IV1312_detrended	0.0727	0.045	1.605	0.113	-0.018	0.163

Omnibus:	4.621	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.113
Prob(Omnibus):	0.099	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	4.541
Skew:	-0.592	**Prob(JB):**	0.103
Kurtosis:	2.825	**Cond. No.**	51.1

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

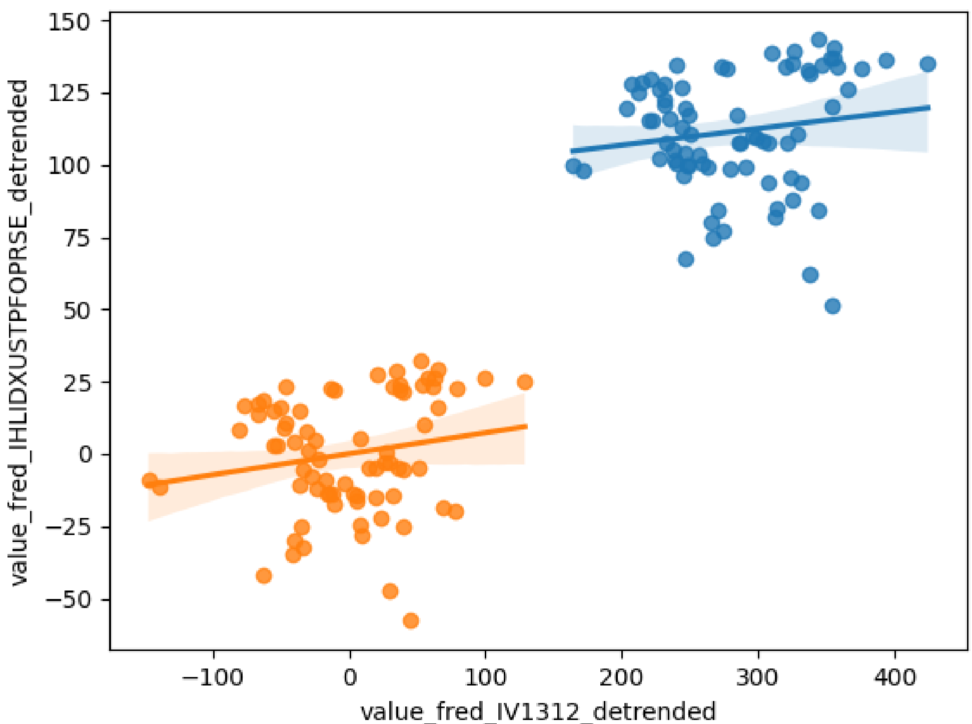

Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-13